

■ Git Clone Guide

CS Lab 2026 · Windows Step-by-Step

1 Install Git for Windows (one time only)

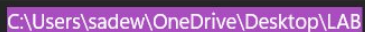
Open your browser and go to <https://git-scm.com/download/win> — the download starts automatically. Run the **.exe** file, click **Next** on every screen, then **Install** → **Finish**.

2 Create Your Lab Folder on the Desktop

Right-click on an empty area of your **Desktop** → **New** → **Folder**. Name it **LAB** (or any name you prefer) and press **Enter**. Then **double-click** the folder to open it in File Explorer.

3 Open Command Prompt Inside Your Folder

Inside File Explorer, click the **address bar** at the top. The full path becomes highlighted in blue — like this:



The address bar turns blue/selected when you click it

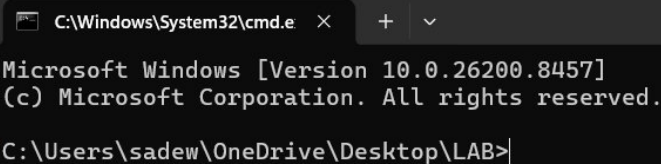
Now type **cmd** and you will see a suggestion appear below:



cmd

Type cmd — a suggestion appears. Press Enter.

Press **Enter**. A black Command Prompt window opens — already pointing to your LAB folder:



CMD opens directly inside your LAB folder — notice the path in the prompt

4 Clone the Repository

In the CMD window, type the command below and press **Enter**:

```
git clone https://github.com/sadewnethsara/CS-Lab-2026.git
```

■ **How to paste in CMD:** Copy the command above, then **right-click** anywhere inside the CMD window — it pastes automatically. Then press **Enter**.

```
C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe

C:\Users\sadew\OneDrive\Desktop\LAB> git clone https://github.com/sadewnethsara/CS-Lab-2026.git
Cloning into 'CS-Lab-2026'...
remote: Enumerating objects: 12, done.
remote: Counting objects: 100% (12/12), done.
Receiving objects: 100% (12/12), 8.45 KiB | 1.2 MiB/s, done.
Folder 'CS-Lab-2026' created successfully inside LAB.
C:\Users\sadew\OneDrive\Desktop\LAB>
```

Successful clone — a new CS-Lab-2026 folder is created inside your LAB folder

5 Get the Latest Files (git pull)

Whenever your instructor uploads new files, open your **CS-Lab-2026** folder in File Explorer, click the address bar, type **cmd** and press **Enter**. Then run:

git pull

```
C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe

C:\Users\sadew\OneDrive\Desktop\LAB> cd CS-Lab-2026
C:\Users\sadew\OneDrive\Desktop\LAB\CS-Lab-2026> git pull
remote: Enumerating objects: 5, done.
Unpacking objects: 100% (3/3), done.
Day01/EX09.html | 24 ++++++ (new file from instructor)
-- or if no updates --
Already up to date.
```

cd into the project folder, then run git pull to download new files

6 Open & Edit Files

Option A — VS Code (Recommended)

If you have **VS Code** installed, run this command in CMD to open the entire project folder instantly:

code .

```
C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe

C:\Users\sadew\OneDrive\Desktop\LAB\CS-Lab-2026> code .
VS Code opens with all project files in the sidebar.
-- make sure VS Code is installed first --
-- https://code.visualstudio.com --
```

code . opens VS Code with all project files ready in the sidebar

■ VS Code also has a built-in **Live Preview** extension (by Microsoft). Install it from the Extensions panel (Ctrl+Shift+X), search **Live Preview**, click Install. Then right-click any **.html** file → **Show Preview** to see it live inside VS Code.

Option B — Notepad++ (if you don't have VS Code)

Download Notepad++ from <https://notepad-plus-plus.org/downloads> — it's free. Run the installer with all defaults.

Install the NppExec / Live Preview Plugin:

1. Open Notepad++ → click **Plugins** in the top menu → **Plugins Admin...**
2. In the search box type **NppExec** and install it.
3. Also search for **Preview HTML** — if it appears, install it too.

■■ **Important:** The Notepad++ live preview plugin has limited support — CSS and JavaScript may not work correctly in the preview panel. If it does not show your page properly, use the method below instead.

Best way to preview HTML in Notepad++:

Open your project folder in File Explorer, find your **index.html** file and **double-click** it — it will open directly in your default web browser (Chrome, Edge, etc.) and you can see the full live result. After saving changes in Notepad++, just press **F5** in the browser to refresh.

■ Quick Summary

When	Command	What it does
Once only	<code>git clone https://github.com/sadewnethsara/CS-Lab-2026.git</code>	Downloads the project
Every session	<code>git pull</code>	Gets latest files from instructor
Open in VS Code	<code>code .</code>	Opens entire project in VS Code

If you see any error, take a screenshot and show it to me.